

Kudzaishe Zharare

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Experience

Poza 2025 - Present

Founder and Software Engineer

- Translated 56 merchant and payments interviews into requirements, user journeys, and technical designs, establishing the scope for a financial app
- Built mobile and web account workflows with identity verification and backend services; connected wallets, payments, and brokerage flows in development and sandbox
- Designed wallet accounting and reconciliation to prevent duplicate deposit credits and keep balances traceable to settled funds

Cleva Technologies (YC W24) Apr 2024 - 2025

Lead Software Engineer

- Reduced identity verification waits from 2 days to 3 weeks to under a minute for eligible completed submissions by automating document checks and decision workflows
- Built verification infrastructure used as the platform grew beyond 1 million users, including duplicate detection and reasoned referral of uncertain cases for manual review
- Built configurable verification rules so compliance changes could be applied without rewriting the decision flow, with consistent approval, denial, and review outcomes

FlexID Technologies 2021 - 2023

CTO, later Co-Founder

- Built self-sovereign identity wallets with verifiable credentials, enabling users to hold and present digital records across mobile and web applications
- Applied zero-knowledge proofs and selective disclosure to verify claims without exposing full records
- Led a distributed engineering team delivering wallet applications, encrypted credential handling, backend services, and cloud infrastructure

Motapa, trading as Mutapa 2020 - 2021

Founder and Systems Architect

- Led a 5-person team delivering merchant payment systems across education, retail, and healthcare; coordinated bank liaison, integration testing, and merchant training
- Built Mutapa Marketplace, acquired by CBZ Holdings; continued payment support through 2022

The World Bank 2019 - 2020

Country Lead Engineer, DRIVER Project (SDC contract)

- Built a national crash-reporting application and dashboards; coordinated rollout with police, ambulance services, and the Ministry of Health

Skills

Engineering: Full-stack development, API design, data modeling, systems integration

Infrastructure: Cloud architecture, deployment automation, Linux, troubleshooting

Identity and payments: Verifiable credentials, selective disclosure, transaction processing

Education

Massachusetts Institute of Technology 2019

B.S. in Computer Science and Mathematics